How College Students Change Their Writing for Different Audiences

Introduction

People have a tendency to speak and write differently around different audiences. Some people become more respectful towards authorities but more familiar tones with peers. Audience seems to influence the way people write, and I was curious about how this related to myself and my collegiate peers. This paper is about researching how and why do college students change their writing for various audiences. this is the beginning of my intro can you write the rest. Researchers have studied how audiences and purposes influence writing. Black examines how students change persuasive writing based on the understanding of their audiences (Black). This suggests that knowing who will read something can affect not only what a person might say but what they choose to say. Collin also explains that writing choices are influenced by audience, purpose, and the situation which the writing takes place in (Collin). These factors can help explain why a student might write a formal email to a professor but use shorter, casual language when texting a friend. Other research looks at how people change their writing for different situations. Cho and Choi examine how an intended audience affects the way students summarize information from sources (Cho and Choi). Wong looks at how writers think about their audience and purpose while composing (Wong). Together these sources

suggest that writing isn't simply the putting of thoughts onto paper. Writers also make decisions based on who they expect to read their work and what they want to accomplish.

Methods

To collect primary data for this research I created a Google Survey titled "How College Students Change Their Writing for Different Audiences." I chose a survey because it allows me to collect responses from multiple students without having to schedule interviews. It gives participants the opportunity to describe their own writing habits and explain their approach towards different situations.

The survey begins by asking whether participants are currently college or university students. It also asks about their major or general field of study and their year in college. These questions can help me understand what types of students responded and what people from different academic backgrounds report different writing habits. The survey also asks participants whether they change the way they write depending on who will read their message.

The main part of the survey uses hypothetical situations with different audiences. For example, participants are asked how they would write a message to a professor explaining that they will miss class. They are given multiple select answers so their options exclusive. Are given the following instructions "the rest of the survey will interview the way you would respond to specific purposes and audiences. you can select more than one answer if you want and write custom ways you'd respond in the "other"

section. If you want, you can take note of extenuating circumstances that might change, you'd write in the "other" section too.” This leaves a good amount of easily defined categorical data, but also some room to notice patterns I may not have anticipated in the “other” section

I'm distributing this survey as of writing this so I want to not talk too much about the method I distributed within this draft.

Results and Analysis

Since the survey responses still need to be collected, the results section will be completed after the data is available.

If you are a peer review feel free to take it:How College Students Change Their Writing for Different Audiences

I plan to compare writing to professors and writing to close friends. These situations have different expectations, even though both involve communicating information to another person.

Ill compare my results with the writings ive selected and see if they match and probably disclose some discrepancies my results are sure to have.

Discussion

The main purpose of this research is to understand how and why college students change their writing. College students communicate with many different people throughout the day, and these interactions do not all have the same expectations. The question of how collage students change there writing is worth investigating because it gives insight into how they perceive tone and its relation/purpose in regard to their audience.

Writing to a professor may involve being respectful and explaining a situation clearly, conversely; writing to a friend may involve getting the point across quickly and not worrying as much about formal grammar or complete sentences. These tones are not interchangeable and could create issues if used in the wrong situation. The effectiveness of a message depends partly on whether the writing fits the situation and communicates what the writer intends.

This idea is described in Collin's discussion of how writing is shaped by audience, purpose, and context (Collin). A writer has to consider more than the information being communicated. They may also need to consider what the reader already knows, how the reader might interpret the message, and what response the writer wants. These decisions happen for everyone, but collage students experience specific audiences more than other demographics.

Another question is whether students make these changes consciously. Some people might think carefully about their wording before sending an email to a professor. Others might change their writing automatically because they are familiar with the expectations of that situation. These are two different ways that audience can influence communication. The survey may help identify whether students recognize these changes

in their own writing, they will reflect what they report about themselves rather than directly observing how they write.

There are also limitations to this research. Because the survey will be shared through Discord servers and personal contacts, the participants will not be a random sample of college students. Some groups of students may be more likely to respond than others. Additionally, hypothetical situations may not perfectly reflect how people actually write. A person might say they would send a formal email to a professor but use a different style when they are in a hurry or dealing with a stressful situation.

The survey also focuses on a limited number of situations. Students communicate with many other audiences, including strangers, online communities, customers, and people they meet through extracurricular activities. The responses will provide a limited view of the ways college students adjust their writing. Still, the survey can provide a starting point for understanding common patterns in everyday communication.

Conclusion

Writing is a regular part of college life, but the way students communicate can change depending on who they are talking to and what they are trying to accomplish. A message to a professor may require a different approach than a text to a friend, even though both messages communicate similar information. Research on audiences and purposes suggests that these decisions are an important part of writing rather than something that only matters in academic assignments.

Through my survey I hope to identify patterns in how college students approach different writing situations. By comparing responses involving professors, friends, employers, classmates, and family members I can examine which styles students prefer, and what factors influence their choices. The results may also show that writing habits are more complicated than simply choosing between formal and casual language.

Further research could explore these questions by interviewing students, observing examples of their writing with their permission, or collecting responses from a larger and more diverse group of colleges. It could also compare how students communicate through different formats, like emails, text messages, discussion boards, and social media. Overall, understanding how students adjust their writing can help explain how people communicate with different audiences and why the same person may write in several different ways.

Works Cited

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